Monthly patching schedule and what to expect

Article KB0010046 | Owner: Desktop Support | Subcategory: OS update failure | Applies to: Windows 11 23H2/24H2 (Dell Latitude 5440/7440, Lenovo ThinkPad T14/X1 Carbon, HP EliteBook 840), macOS 14/15 (MacBook Pro/Air), Devices managed by Microsoft Intune, Users connecting via VPN or on-site

Summary

Acme Global follows a monthly Patch Tuesday cadence for Windows devices and regular security updates for macOS. This article explains the patching timeline, what users may see during the process, common reasons updates fail, and provides step-by-step self-help actions as well as the service-desk workflow for resolving patch-related incidents.

Symptoms

- Windows Update shows "Failed to install" or "Error 0x8007000d"
- Update progress bar stuck at 0% or 99%
- System repeatedly rolls back after restart with message "We couldn't complete the updates. Undoing changes"
- macOS Software Update reports "Unable to install update" or "An error occurred while preparing the update"
- Laptop restarts for updates but hangs on a black screen or the Apple logo

Common causes

- Insufficient free disk space (<10?GB) on the system drive
- Interrupted network connectivity (VPN off, Wi-Fi drop) during download
- Corrupted Windows Update components or missing prerequisite updates
- Third-party software or antivirus blocking the update process
- macOS insufficient free space or incompatible firmware version
- Pending reboot required from previous patch cycle

Overview of the Monthly Patching Process

Acme Global's Desktop Support team deploys Windows security updates on the second Tuesday of each month (Patch Tuesday). Updates are made available through Microsoft Intune and typically appear in the Company Portal within a few hours. Users have five days to install the updates before a mandatory restart deadline is enforced. macOS receives security updates via Apple's MDM channel and are pushed similarly; users are prompted to install and restart when ready.

User Self-Help Checklist (Quick Checks)

Before diving into deeper troubleshooting, verify these common conditions. If any item is not met, correct it and then retry Windows Update or macOS Software Update.

1. Ensure you are connected to the corporate network: either on-site Wi-Fi (ACME-Corp) or the GlobalProtect VPN (vpn.acme.example).
2. Check free space on the system drive: open File Explorer -> This PC, right-click C: -> Properties; confirm at least 10?GB free. On macOS, ? -> About This Mac -> Storage; aim for >=10?GB available.
3. Disconnect any non-essential peripherals (USB docks, external monitors) that could interfere with restart.
4. Close all open applications and save work; you will need to restart.
5. If using a laptop, plug in the AC adapter to avoid power loss during the update.

Numbered Self-Help Procedure - Resolving a Stuck Windows Update

Follow these steps when Windows Update appears to have failed, is stuck at 0%, or rolls back after restart. The procedure resets update components, clears temporary files, and retries the install.

1. Open an elevated Command Prompt: press Win?+?X -> Windows Terminal (Admin) -> Yes.
2. Stop the update services by typing each line and pressing Enter:
net stop wuauserv
net stop cryptSvc
net stop bits
net stop msiserver
3. Rename the SoftwareDistribution and Catroot2 folders:
ren C:\Windows\SoftwareDistribution SoftwareDistribution.old
ren C:\Windows\System32\catroot2 Catroot2.old
4. Restart the services:
net start wuauserv
net start cryptSvc
net start bits
net start msiserver

5. Close the Command Prompt window.
6. Open Settings -> Windows Update -> Check for updates. Install any offered updates and restart when prompted.

Service-Desk Agent Procedure

When a user contacts the IT Help Desk with a patch-related incident, follow this workflow to diagnose and resolve the issue efficiently.

1. Verify the user's symptom and collect the exact error message or behavior (e.g., "Update stuck at 0%", error code).
2. Confirm network connectivity: ask the user to ensure they are on ACME-Corp Wi-Fi or connected to GlobalProtect VPN; if not, guide them to connect.
3. Check available disk space remotely via Intune or ask the user to confirm >=10?GB free; if insufficient, advise cleaning temporary files or moving data to OneDrive.
4. Run the Windows Update Troubleshooter from Settings -> System -> Troubleshoot -> Other troubleshooters -> Windows Update, or execute the built-in diagnostic script via Intune if needed.
5. If the troubleshooter does not resolve the issue, instruct the user to perform the self-help component reset procedure detailed above.
6. For macOS, verify free space, ensure the device is plugged in, then run Software Update again; if it fails, advise downloading the latest combo updater from Apple's support site and installing manually.
7. After applying fixes, confirm the update installs successfully and the device restarts without rolling back.
8. Document the resolution steps in the ticket and close with a confirmation request from the user.

Verification and Confirmation

After the update process completes, both users and agents should verify that the system is fully patched and operational.

1. On Windows, open Settings -> Windows Update -> View update history; ensure the latest Patch Tuesday KB appears with status "Installed".
2. On macOS, open ? -> System Settings -> General -> Software Update; confirm the version matches the latest released build.
3. Check that critical applications (Outlook, Teams, Company Portal) launch correctly and that BitLocker/FileVault status remains normal.
4. If the user experiences any abnormal behavior (slow performance, missing drives), ask them to reboot once more and re-check update status.

Prevention and Best Practices

Adopting a few habits reduces the likelihood of patch-related failures and keeps devices within SLA targets.

1. Keep at least 15?GB free on the system drive to accommodate cumulative updates and temporary files.
2. Leave the laptop plugged in and connected to the corporate network overnight on Patch Tuesday; Intune will install updates automatically.
3. Avoid pausing or deferring feature updates unless explicitly approved by Desktop Support; security updates should never be deferred.
4. Periodically run the Company Portal sync (or Intune Company Portal app) to ensure the device receives the latest policies.
5. Educate end-users to use the "Report" button in Outlook for any phishing attempts that may masquerade as update notifications.

When to escalate

If the user's update issue persists after the self-help component reset and the service-desk agent has verified network connectivity, sufficient disk space, and that the Windows Update Troubleshooter or macOS Software Update still fails, escalate to the Desktop Support - OS Engineering sub-team. Include in the escalation: the exact error code or message, screenshots of the update history, Intune device compliance report, and a summary of troubleshooting steps already performed. For macOS failures that remain after manual combo updater attempts, escalate to the Desktop Support - macOS Specialist group with the same details.

Keywords: Windows Update, patch Tuesday, update stuck, update failed, error 0x8007000d, rollback, macOS update, software update failed, Intune,

Company Portal, disk space, VPN, GlobalProtect, troubleshooter, component reset, services reset